Congratulations—you've made it all the way through this detailed discussion of routing! Routing is one of those topics that people often get stuck on when they come to building an application, which can be frustrating. We'll revisit routing when we look at Razor Pages in chapter 14 and web API controllers in chapter 20, but rest assured that this chapter has covered all the tricky details!

In chapter 7 we'll dive into model binding. You'll see how the route values generated during routing are bound to your endpoint handler parameters and, perhaps more important, how to validate the values you're provided.

Summary

- Routing is the process of mapping an incoming request URL to an endpoint that executes to generate a response. Routing provides flexibility to your API implementations, enabling you to map multiple URLs to a single endpoint, for example.
- ASP.NET Core uses two pieces of middleware for routing. The `EndpointRoutingMiddleware` and the `EndpointMiddleware`. `WebApplication` adds both pieces of middleware to your pipeline by default, so typically, you don't add them to your application manually.
- The `EndpointRoutingMiddleware` selects which endpoint should be executed by using routing to match the request URL. The `EndpointMiddleware` executes the endpoint. Having two separate middleware components means that middleware placed between them can react based on the endpoint that will execute when it reaches the end of the pipeline.